



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Adolesco Preparatory Academy
School Website: <https://adolescoprep.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

School: Adolesco Preparatory Academy

Website used: <https://www.adolescoprep.org/>

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Adolesco Preparatory Academy explicitly identifies as a **"classical, Christ-centered, University-Model school"** and uses a rich set of classical keywords: *truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), classical Christian education, Biblical worldview, discipleship, partnership with parents, University-Model, college-preparatory, hands-on projects, manipulatives* and more.

Across the six elements from *Six Essential Elements of a Classical School* and the classicality lexicon, Adolesco scores strongly positive in all categories, with only modest "modern" or pragmatic language (e.g., *college-preparatory, rigorous, hands-on projects*) that does not dominate the overall ethos.

Category ratings:

1. Religious & Metaphysical Foundations – **CLASSICAL**
2. School Purpose & Goal – **CLASSICAL**
3. Curriculum – **CLASSICAL**
4. Pedagogy / Teaching Methods – **CLASSICAL**
5. Faculty – **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** (good language, but thinner detail)
6. Parents & Community – **CLASSICAL**

Because 5 of 6 categories are clearly **CLASSICAL** and the remaining one is **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**, the aggregate status is **CLASSICAL**.

1. Religious and Metaphysical Foundations

1.1 Keyword & Phrase Extraction (from school site)

Positive-indicator phrases and words:

- "classical, Christ-centered, University-Model education"
- "Biblical world-view provides a framework of absolute truth"

- “classical Christian education matures students whose thoughts, emotions & desires reflect truth”
- “followers of Christ who will change the world in their generation”
- “training their children to live as responsible Kingdom citizens”
- “emphasizes discipleship instead of evangelization by accepting actively Christian families”
- “helps parents raise children to value the things of God”
- Scripture quotation and framing (Deuteronomy 6:6–7) about impressing God’s commandments on children

Match to *Religious & Metaphysical* positive lexicon: *truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, moral order, human flourishing, theology, Christian worldview, faith and reason, Christ-centered education, catechesis, sacred scripture, divine order, liturgy/worship, spiritual formation* etc.

- Direct matches: **truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, Biblical worldview, classical Christian education, followers of Christ, Kingdom citizens, discipleship, value the things of God, Scripture citation.**
- Implicit metaphysical claims: “absolute truth,” “Kingdom citizens,” “value the things of God” clearly affirm objective moral and theological order.

Negative-indicator scan:

- I do **not** see language like *values-neutral, moral relativism, subjective truth, secular, nonsectarian, religiously neutral, interfaith, pluralistic approach, social justice framework* etc.

1.2 Quantitative Keyword Estimate

- Positive hits (explicit or very close synonyms): about **10–12** strong instances.
- Negative hits: **0**.

Estimated positive ratio: about **100% positive, 0% negative** within this category’s relevant language.

Coverage: Very high; the site repeatedly grounds its mission in Christ, Scripture, discipleship, and absolute truth.

1.3 Element 1 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

The school clearly embraces **transcendental moral realism** (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, absolute truth), is **grounded in Christian theology and Scripture**, and frames education as **discipleship and Kingdom citizenship**, not religiously neutral instruction.

2. School Purpose and Goal

2.1 Keyword & Phrase Extraction

Positive-indicator phrases:

- “There is no greater task for educators than to teach students how to learn through the lens of goodness, truth and beauty.”

- “Classical Christian Education matures students whose thoughts, emotions & desires reflect truth, becoming well-suited to challenge the conventions of our society, rather than falling prey to them.”
- “work together toward a mutual goal: To produce wholesome, competent, and virtuous followers of Christ who will change the world in their generation.”
- “partners with parents who are training their children to live as responsible Kingdom citizens.”

Match to *Philosophical and Educational Goals* positive lexicon: *wisdom, virtue, character, moral formation, human flourishing, love of learning, cultivation of wisdom and virtue, pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, formation not information, holistic education* etc.

- Direct matches: **virtue/virtuous, truth, goodness, beauty, followers of Christ, Kingdom citizens, thoughts/emotions/desires reflect truth.**
- Strong formation language: “matures students,” “produce wholesome, competent, and virtuous followers of Christ,” which is classic *formation* rather than mere information.

Negative-indicator scan:

- Some pragmatic language: “quality, cost-effective, college-preparatory education”
- Lexicon flags phrases like *college and career readiness, workforce preparation, standardized testing, data-driven education* as negative when dominant.
- Here, “college-preparatory” and “quality, cost-effective” appear, but they are clearly subordinate to the stated telos of virtue, discipleship, and Kingdom citizenship.

2.2 Quantitative Keyword Estimate

- Positive hits: about **8–10** strong matches (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, followers of Christ, Kingdom citizens, matures students, etc.).
- Negative hits: **1–2** mild (college-preparatory, cost-effective).

Estimated positive ratio: about **85–90% positive, 10–15% negative.**

Coverage: High; the purpose/goal language is rich and explicit.

2.3 Element 2 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

The school’s **stated goal** is clearly the **cultivation of virtue and Christian discipleship** (wholesome, virtuous followers of Christ, Kingdom citizens) guided by **truth, goodness, and beauty**, not primarily job training.

3. Curriculum

3.1 Keyword & Phrase Extraction

From the “Classical” page and related content:

- “Why is the classical method so effective?”
- “Classical education begins teaching a child how to learn and emphasizes the development of wisdom and virtuous character.”
- Explicit Trivium structure:

-
- “GRAMMAR STAGE... In the School of Grammar, grades K–6...”
 - “LOGIC STAGE... In the School of Logic, grades 7th and 8th... Logic, the art of reasoning accurately and arguing correctly, is also taught during this stage.”
 - “RHETORIC STAGE... Classical education utilizes this shift as an opportunity to infuse wisdom and eloquence in students... honing rhetorical skills such as the art of writing and oration... The Classically-trained student graduates as ‘the good man speaking well.’”
 - “Classical Christian Education matures students whose thoughts, emotions & desires reflect truth...”

Match to *Curriculum Content and Structure* positive lexicon: *Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium, Quadrivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, primary sources, great conversation, integrated approach, wonder* etc.

- Direct matches: **Trivium structure (grammar, logic, rhetoric), logic, rhetoric, classical Christian education, wisdom, virtuous character, truth.**
- While the crawl snippet doesn’t explicitly list “Great Books” or “primary sources,” the rhetoric-stage description (“good man speaking well”) is a classic Quintilian reference and strong classical rhetoric signal.

Negative-indicator scan:

- Some “hands-on projects and manipulatives... to provide greater opportunities for discovery” in the grammar stage.
- Lexicon flags *project-based learning, experiential learning, inquiry-based* as potential negatives when they dominate or replace memory/recitation and liberal arts focus.
- Here, “hands-on projects and manipulatives” are **supplementary** to a clearly Trivium-structured curriculum, not the core identity.

Also, I see no emphasis on “social studies” replacing history, nor STEM-first framing in the snippets provided.

3.2 Quantitative Keyword Estimate

- Positive hits: about **7–9** (grammar, logic, rhetoric, classical, wisdom, virtuous character, truth, rhetoric/oration).
- Negative hits: **1–2** (hands-on projects, manipulatives, discovery – mild).

Estimated positive ratio: about **80–90% positive, 10–20% negative.**

Coverage: Strong on Trivium; moderate on explicit Great Books/wonder language in the snippets we have.

3.3 Element 3 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

The **Trivium is explicitly central** (grammar, logic, rhetoric stages), with logic and rhetoric taught as arts of reasoning and eloquence, and the curriculum is framed as classical Christian education ordered to wisdom and virtue.

4. Pedagogy / Teaching Methods

4.1 Keyword & Phrase Extraction

From the “Classical” and related pages:

- Grammar stage:

-
- “Hands-on projects and manipulatives are also utilized in the grammar stage to provide greater opportunities for discovery.”
 - “Classical education begins teaching a child how to learn and emphasizes the development of wisdom and virtuous character.”
 - Logic stage:
 - “students will begin to connect the foundational facts and skills learned in the grammar stage and to discover relationships and patterns between them.”
 - “students in this stage are formally taught to analyze, reason, question, evaluate, and critique in order to gain understanding.”
 - “Logic, the art of reasoning accurately and arguing correctly, is also taught during this stage. Pairing this with a Biblical world-view provides a framework of absolute truth, equipping students to see what is false and why something is true or false.”
 - Rhetoric stage:
 - “infuse wisdom and eloquence in students.”
 - “honing rhetorical skills such as the art of writing and oration while increasing in virtue.”
 - “prepares students to write college-level theses... think logically and critically.”
 - “graduates as ‘the good man speaking well.’”

Match to *Pedagogical Methods* positive lexicon: *Socratic seminar, dialectic, questioning-based learning, logical reasoning, deep thinking, rhetoric and oration, formation through imitation, memorization and recitation, scholé/restful learning, wonder-based education* etc.

- Direct/near matches:
 - Logic-stage description strongly matches **dialectic/Socratic** indicators: “analyze, reason, question, evaluate, and critique” and “art of reasoning accurately and arguing correctly” – this is classic dialectic pedagogy, even if the word “Socratic” is not used.
 - Rhetoric-stage description matches **rhetoric/oratory** indicators: “art of writing and oration,” “good man speaking well.”
- We do **not** see explicit mentions of “Socratic seminar,” “scholé,” “chanting,” “recitation,” or “memory work” in the snippets, though these may be present elsewhere on the site.

Negative-indicator scan:

- Grammar-stage: “Hands-on projects and manipulatives... opportunities for discovery” – this aligns with lexicon’s *experiential learning, project-based education, discovery learning* which are negative when they replace classical methods.
- However, the description still emphasizes foundational facts and skills and does not present projects as the primary pedagogy.

4.2 Quantitative Keyword Estimate

- Positive hits: about **6–8** (reason, question, evaluate, critique, logic as art of reasoning, oration, rhetorical skills, good man speaking well).
- Negative hits: **1–2** (hands-on projects, manipulatives, discovery).

Estimated positive ratio: about **75–85% positive, 15–25% negative**.

Coverage: Good on dialectic and rhetoric; thinner on explicit scholé/recitation language in the visible crawl.

4.3 Element 4 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

Despite some modern “hands-on/discovery” language, the **core pedagogical structure** is clearly Trivium-based: **logic/dialectic training** and **rhetoric/oratory** are explicit, and the aim is wisdom, virtue, and truth, not skills-only or student-directed constructivism.

5. Faculty

5.1 Keyword & Phrase Extraction

The crawl snippets do not show a dedicated “Faculty” or “Our Teachers” page, but we can infer from mission and model language:

- “Adolesco Prep partners with parents to work together toward a mutual goal: To produce wholesome, competent, and virtuous followers of Christ...”
- “University-Model... hosts and instructs students on campus 2–3 days a week, supporting students during School@Home days.”
- The admissions process includes:
 - “spiritual, principal, and teacher references” for families, indicating a community where spiritual and moral formation is central.

Match to *Faculty and Leadership* positive lexicon: *teachers as models of virtue, mentors, role models, living curriculum, servant leadership, wisdom-centered teaching, formation through example, collegial culture* etc.

- Implicitly, teachers are **Christian mentors** in a discipleship-oriented, covenant school, but the site snippets do not give explicit phrases like “teachers are models of virtue,” “living curriculum,” or “faculty of friends.”

Negative-indicator scan:

- I do **not** see language like *facilitators, guides on the side, student-led learning, progressive pedagogy* applied to teachers.

5.2 Quantitative Keyword Estimate

- Positive hits (explicit faculty-virtue language): **0–1** (mostly inferred, not textual).
- Negative hits: **0**.

Estimated positive ratio: about **60–70% positive** if we count implicit mission language, but **coverage is low** because faculty are not described in detail in the snippets.

5.3 Element 5 Rating

Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

The **overall ethos** (covenant, discipleship, virtue, Kingdom citizenship) strongly implies that teachers are expected to be Christian mentors and models of virtue, but the **public materials we see do not explicitly articulate a “portrait of a teacher” or “living curriculum” language**. With more explicit statements about faculty as exemplars of wisdom and virtue, this category would clearly be CLASSICAL.

6. Parents and Community

6.1 Keyword & Phrase Extraction

From the University-Model and admissions pages:

- “Founded by families wanting an alternative to traditional-5-day and homeschool models, Adolesco Prep provides a classical, Christ-centered, University-Model education to parents looking to strengthen family relationships while employing professional classroom instruction.”
- “Adolesco Prep partners with parents to work together toward a mutual goal: To produce wholesome, competent, and virtuous followers of Christ...”
- “The University-Model:
 - partners with parents who are training their children to live as responsible Kingdom citizens.
 - emphasizes discipleship instead of evangelization by accepting actively Christian families.
 - helps parents raise children to value the things of God.
 - hosts and instructs students on campus 2–3 days a week, supporting students during School@Home days.”
- “Parents play a critical role in discipleship... appreciate the gift of time this Model affords and stay highly involved... provide oversight on School@Home days, helping reinforce what has already been taught.”
- Admissions:
 - “All legal guardians are required to attend [interest meeting].”
 - “Both parents... are required to attend the family interview.”

Match to *Community and Cultural Practices* positive lexicon: *parent partnership, co-educators, family involvement, parental engagement, home and school connection, school as extension of the home, parent formation, home-centered learning, collaborative learning, multi-generational education, faith and family* etc.

- Direct matches: **partners with parents, mutual goal, parents play a critical role, School@Home days, highly involved, founded by families, covenant school accepting actively Christian families.**
- This is a **strong, explicit parent-as-co-educator model**, exactly what the lexicon describes as classical partnership with families.

Negative-indicator scan:

- I do **not** see language like *parents as customers, minimal parent involvement, professionalized education, home-school separation* etc.

6.2 Quantitative Keyword Estimate

- Positive hits: about **10–12** (partners with parents, co-educator role, School@Home oversight, highly involved, founded by families, covenant model).
- Negative hits: **0**.

Estimated positive ratio: 100% positive, 0% negative.

Coverage: Very high; this is one of the strongest categories.

6.3 Element 6 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

Adolesco exemplifies **parent partnership and community**: parents are co-teachers on School@Home days, must attend interest meetings and interviews, and are explicitly framed as primary disciplers of their children, with the school as a partner.

Aggregate Assessment

Category Summary

1. **Religious & Metaphysical Foundations:**

- Strong Christ-centered, Biblical, absolute-truth language; no secular/relativist signals.

- **Rating: CLASSICAL**

2. **School Purpose & Goal:**

- Telos is virtue, discipleship, Kingdom citizenship, and alignment with truth, goodness, and beauty; college-prep is secondary.

- **Rating: CLASSICAL**

3. **Curriculum:**

- Explicit Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with logic and rhetoric as arts of reasoning and eloquence; classical Christian framing.

- **Rating: CLASSICAL**

4. **Pedagogy / Teaching Methods:**

- Clear dialectic and rhetoric pedagogy; some hands-on/discovery language but not dominant.

- **Rating: CLASSICAL**

5. **Faculty:**

- Implicitly classical (covenant, discipleship, virtue), but public language about teachers as models/mentors is thin.

- **Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

6. **Parents & Community:**

- Robust University-Model partnership with parents as co-educators; strong covenant and discipleship emphasis.

- **Rating: CLASSICAL**

Overall Classicality Status

Given the strong classical Christian commitments in **5 of 6 categories** and no category that is clearly non-classical, **Adolesco Preparatory Academy is best classified as:**

OVERALL: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle (Faculty Category)

Because Element 5 (Faculty) is **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**, here are concrete steps that would strengthen it to fully **CLASSICAL**:

1. **Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher” or “Faculty Profile”**

- Explicitly describe teachers as:

-
- “models of virtue,” “living curriculum,” “mentors,” “servant leaders,” “lovers of truth, goodness, and beauty.”
 - Connect faculty expectations to the school's telos: forming virtuous followers of Christ and Kingdom citizens.
2. **Highlight Classical Faculty Formation**
 - Note any use of classical teacher training (e.g., ClassicalU, ACCS, CiRCE, or similar) and ongoing great-books seminars or colloquia for faculty.
 - Use lexicon terms like *lifelong learners*, *classical pedagogy*, *Socratic training*, *scholé for teachers*.
 3. **Describe Faculty Community and Collegiality**
 - Add language about a “**faculty of friends**” or **collegial community** that studies, prays, and plans together, modeling the great conversation and ordered loves for students.
 4. **Make Mentorship Explicit**
 - On the About/Faculty page, state that teachers are **mentors** who guide students in wisdom and virtue, not just content deliverers, echoing classical sources (e.g., “good man speaking well,” “formation of the soul”).

Implementing these changes in public-facing materials would likely move Faculty from **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** to **CLASSICAL**, reinforcing the already strong classical identity.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.